

MAHREEN MUSTAFA

mm2462@cantab.ac.uk | LinkedIn | mahreenmustafa.github.io | +1 (512) 766-8538

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Institutional Economics, Public and Fiscal Policy, Environmental Economics

EDUCATION

- Sep 2023 – Present **Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), MA, USA**
MicroMasters Program in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy (DEDP), Department of Economics
- Grade: A | Track: International Development
 - Courses completed: Data Analysis for Social Scientists (A, 99%); The Challenges of Global Poverty (A, 99%); Microeconomics (A, 88%); Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations. Remaining: Foundations of Development Policy.
- Oct 2020 – Jul 2021 **University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK**
M.Phil. in Public Policy, Department of Politics and International Studies (POLIS)
- Lady Judy Moody-Stuart Scholarship (fully funded).
 - **Postgraduate thesis:** “*Reforming Water Governance Policy to Cope with Water Scarcity: The Case of Spain*”; a comparative institutional analysis of water market, pricing, and governance policy models.
- Aug 2015 – May 2019 **Asian University for Women (AUW), Chittagong, Bangladesh**
B.A. in Economics, Department of Economics
- CGPA 4.21/4.30 (Ranked 1st), Valedictorian, Summa Cum Laude, Andy Matsui Award for Highest Academic Achievement and Leadership.
 - Minors: Mathematics and Finance.
 - **Undergraduate thesis:** “*The Rohingya Exodus: Impact of Forced Migration on Education, Healthcare, and Financial Stability of Refugees*”; based on original field survey of 1,800 refugees and 500 nationals.
- Jun 2018 – Sep 2018 **Harvard Business School, MA, USA**
HBX CORE (Credential of Readiness) Program
- Grade: Pass with Honors (Distinction)
 - Courses: Business Analytics; Financial Accounting; Economics for Managers.

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Sep 2023 – Present **Economics Researcher**
Outlier, Austin, TX
- Evaluate AI-generated economic analyses across microeconomics, macroeconomics, development economics, and public and fiscal policy for theoretical and empirical accuracy; design advanced problems to strengthen causal reasoning and econometric logic.
- Jul 2022 – Sep 2023 **Corporate Sustainability & Climate Change Consultant**
Environmental Resources Management (ERM), Austin, TX
- Led ESG and climate advisory engagements for clients including Goldman Sachs, Target, and Nucor, including TCFD reporting, GHG scoping, and climate due diligence on acquisition deals.
- Sep 2021 – Mar 2022 **Senior Research Associate**
Policy Research Institute (PRI) of Bangladesh, Dhaka
- Led econometric research across nine projects commissioned by the World Bank, ADB, IFC, and Bangladesh's Ministry of Finance and Planning Commission, including country diagnostics for Building Back a Greener Bangladesh and the Country Climate and Development Report.

- Mar 2021 – May 2021 **Policy Advisor**
Kivu International Ltd., Oxford, UK
- Led a comparative assessment of climate adaptation and mitigation policy across Southern Africa's agricultural sector, commissioned by the FCDO.
- Dec 2017 – Mar 2018 **Research Development Intern**
Al-Arafah Islami Bank Limited (AIBL), Chittagong, Bangladesh
- Conducted statistical research comparing the role of conventional and Islamic banking systems in Bangladesh's economic development using panel data analysis.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Jun 2019 – May 2020 **Faculty Member, HBX CORE Program**
Asian University for Women (AUW), Chittagong, Bangladesh
- Taught and monitored Harvard Business School's HBX CORE program (Business Analytics, Economics for Managers, Financial Accounting) as an Economics elective and Finance minor course for 10 final-year students, raising average scores from approximately 60% to 85%.
- Sep 2017 – May 2019 **Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics**
Asian University for Women (AUW), Chittagong, Bangladesh
- Tutored 288 students across Mathematical Economics, Game Theory, Econometrics, and core micro/macroeconomics courses; proctored exams and supported independent study skills.
- Sep 2016 – May 2019 **Teaching Assistant, Department of Mathematics**
Asian University for Women (AUW), Chittagong, Bangladesh
- Coached 592 students in Probability and Statistics, Calculus I & II, and Linear Algebra; reduced plagiarism incidents from approximately 60% to 5% through proactive monitoring and detection.

PUBLICATIONS

Published:

Mustafa, M. (2025). Integrating Life Cycle Analyses and Circular Economy: A Pathway Towards Sustainable Development in Bangladesh. In *The Contribution of Life Cycle Analyses and Circular Economy to the Sustainable Development Goals* (pp. 313-338). Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-85300-5_15

Chowdhury, S. A., Mustafa, M., Ahmed, M., & Jahan, N. (2020). Community-Based Socioeconomic Development Programs: A Catalyst for SDGs. In *Decent Work and Economic Growth, Encyclopaedia of the UN Sustainable Development Goals* (pp. 72-82). Cham: Springer Nature. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-95867-5_70

Accepted:

Inflation, Human Development, & Economic Growth in Bangladesh: An ARDL Analysis with Implications for SDG 8. *Springer Nature*.

Climate Governance, Social Justice, and Peace in Bangladesh: Pathways Toward Poverty Alleviation. *Springer Nature*.

PROJECTS

- 2022 Bangladesh Infrastructure Governance Assessment, *World Bank, PRI*
- 2022 Bangladesh Partnership for Cleaner Textile (PACT) Phase 2, *IFC, PRI*
- 2022 State of the Economy 2021, *PRI*
- 2022 Country Climate and Development Report (CCDR) – Diagnostics and Data Reports, *World Bank, PRI*
- 2022 IFC FIG Upstream Housing Roundtable Series: Rebuilding the Economy post-COVID through Green Housing Finance and Construction, *World Bank, IFC, PRI*
- 2021 Country diagnostics and engagement strategy for Building Back a Greener Bangladesh (GG4B), *World Bank, CEGIS, ICCCAD, PRI*

2021	Climate-informed Infrastructure Governance & Implementation of the Delta Plan 2100, <i>World Bank, PRI</i>
2021	Bangladesh Climate Change Institutional Assessment (CCIA), <i>World Bank, PRI</i>
2021	Partnership for Market Implementation (PMI) Programme - Readiness Support Plan (RSP) for Carbon Pricing, <i>Ricardo, The World Bank, Government of Bangladesh, PRI</i>
2021	Comparative Assessment of Climate Change Policies in Southern Africa: The case for the Agricultural Sector, <i>KIVU</i>

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

2020-21	Lady Judy Moody-Stuart Scholarship (fully funded), <i>University of Cambridge</i>
2019	Valedictorian, Andy Matsui Award for Highest Academic Achievement and Leadership, <i>AUW</i>
2015–19	AUW Support Foundation Scholarship, <i>AUW</i>

SOFTWARE AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometric & Analytical Methods: Panel data analysis, time-series econometrics (ARDL, ECM), impact evaluation, causal inference, Data Envelopment Analysis (DEA)

Quantitative & Programming Tools: R, STATA, Python, EViews, MATLAB

Policy & Research Applications: Economic Modeling, Empirical Research Design, Data Validation, RCTs, Governance and Development Policy Analysis.

LANGUAGES

English (Professional Proficiency); Bengali (Native); Hindi, Urdu, (Conversational); Arabic, Turkish, Korean (Basic)